and want to deploy their first ASP.NET Core app. But that's not to say that IIS is the only, or best, place to host your application.

In the next section I provide a brief introduction to hosting your app on Linux, behind a reverse proxy like NGINX or Apache. I won't go into configuration of the reverse proxy itself, but I will provide an overview of things to consider and resources you can use to run your applications on Linux.

27.3 Hosting an application in Linux

One of the great new features in ASP.NET Core is the ability to develop and deploy applications cross-platform, whether on Windows, Linux, or macOS. The ability to run on Linux in particular opens the possibility of cheaper deployments to cloud hosting, deploying to small devices like a Raspberry Pi or to Docker containers.

One of the characteristics of Linux is that it's almost infinitely configurable. Although that's definitely a feature, it can also be extremely daunting, especially if you're coming from the Windows world of wizards and GUIs. This section provides an overview of what it takes to run an application on Linux. It focuses on the broad steps you need to take rather than the details of the configuration itself. Instead, I point to resources you can refer to as necessary.

27.3.1 Running an ASP.NET Core app behind a reverse proxy in Linux

You'll be glad to hear that running your application on Linux is largely the same as running your application on Windows with IIS: